

Page 1 of 6 · The Broken Path

Honey-Beats reaches the concert meadow just as the musicians arrive, but the numbered stepping stones are scattered through the tall grass. Flutter-Butter lifts the first three back into a row while Honey taps a rhythm that should lead them to the next neighbour.



Page 2 of 6 · A Gap by Six

The repaired path carries the first drummer forward, then stops at a gap beside the stone marked six. Honey-Beats taps a steady rhythm while Flutter-Butter counts backwards by one beat. The missing neighbour must return before the rest of the band can cross.



Page 3 of 6 · Between Eight and Ten

Near the flower arch, two numbered stones wait with an empty space between them. Flutter-Butter hovers over eight, then ten, while Honey-Beats listens for the beat the counting song has skipped. A xylophone player waits patiently on the bank.



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The musicians begin crossing again, but their path curls into a confusing loop. Its number neighbours are in the correct places, yet one stepping stone points differently from the rest. Honey-Beats studies the symbols while Flutter-Butter keeps the band from following the muddled direction.



Page 5 of 6 · Neighbours of Fifteen

At the final bend, the stone marked fifteen sits alone between two muddy spaces. Flutter-Butter searches for the neighbour that belongs before it, and Honey-Beats searches for the one after it. Both are needed to reconnect the path to the concert stage.



Page 6 of 6 · The Concert Path

The stage lights glow, but the last stepping-stone space is still empty after seventeen, eighteen, nineteen. Every musician waits together at the edge of the meadow. Honey-Beats begins a rising counting song, and Flutter-Butter listens for the number that will finish the path.

Questions for Honey-Beats and the Number Neighbours

Read the story together first. Use one question at each page, then the question at the end. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

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Which number comes after 3?

Choices: 2 · 4 · 5

Page 2 · A Gap by Six

Which number comes before 6?

Choices: 4 · 5 · 7

Page 3 · Between Eight and Ten

Which number belongs between 8 and 10?

Choices: 8 · 9 · 11

Page 4 · The Twisted Stone

Which stone is turned the wrong way?

Choices: The reversed stone · The first stone · The flower stone

Page 5 · Neighbours of Fifteen

Which pair are the neighbours of 15?

Choices: 13 and 14 · 14 and 16 · 16 and 17

Page 6 · The Concert Path

Which number finishes the path?

Choices: 18 · 20 · 21

After reading

What are the neighbours of a number?

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: 4. Four follows three.

Page 2: 5. Five lives between four and six.

Page 3: 9. Nine is the neighbour between eight and ten.

Page 4: The reversed stone. The reversed stone was interrupting the pattern.

Page 5: 14 and 16. Fourteen and sixteen are beside fifteen.

Page 6: 20. Twenty completes the concert path.

After reading: The number just before it and the number just after it. The neighbours of 15 are 14 and 16.

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